



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Joseph's Catholic School
School Website: <https://www.sjcatholicschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit Report: Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School**

Website audited: <https://bishopreicher.com>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Why: The school shows strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (daily prayer, weekly Mass, explicit sacramental and theological formation) and a curriculum that includes classical elements (Latin, "classic literature" with authors such as Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare). Purpose/Goal language includes robust "virtue" formation but is mixed with heavy college-prep framing. Public materials show limited explicit classical pedagogy (e.g., "Socratic," "scholé," "chant/recitation") and do not surface a classical faculty profile or parent formation typical of classical schools. - Standout positives: Four-year theology sequence; explicit "virtues" formation (cardinal and theological virtues); Latin and "classical literature"; regular liturgy (weekly Mass, Eucharist); references to catechesis and sacred scripture. - Key gaps: No visible "Trivium/Quadrivium" claims, no clear "Socratic seminar," "scholé/restful learning," or "chant/recitation" practices in the lower school; faculty ethos not framed as "models/mentors" or "living curriculum"; parent formation not clearly articulated.

Below is the required keyword analysis by the Six Elements, followed by category ratings and the aggregate result.

Six-Element Keyword Analysis and Ratings

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS Criteria highlights: transcendental moral realism; grounded in theology; liturgical/communal worship.

1) Keywords found on the school site

- Positive indicators found: theology; sacred scripture; moral and sacramental life; Church; gospel; daily prayer; weekly Mass; Eucharist; catechesis; virtue (cardinal and theological).
- These map directly to positive lexicon items (e.g., theology, sacred scripture, Eucharist, Mass, catechesis) from the "Six Elements"/lexicon lists.

2) Positive vs. Negative keyword comparison

- Positive hits: theology, sacred scripture, sacramental life, Church, gospel, daily prayer, weekly Mass, Eucharist, catechesis, virtue = 9
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100% (9/9)

3) Coverage estimate

- Coverage of Religious/Foundation lexicon: high (theology, scripture, liturgy, sacraments, catechesis all present). Estimated 80%.

Score: CLASSICAL Justification: The site evidences a robust Catholic theological foundation and regular liturgical life across divisions, aligning with the "Grounded in Theology" and "Liturgical and Communal Practices" sub-elements.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL Criteria highlights: cultivation of virtue/wisdom; formation over mere information; truth, goodness, beauty.

1) Keywords found

- Positive indicators: virtue, faith formation, character, truth; explicit virtues program (prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance; faith, hope, charity) and “partner with families” in virtue formation.
- Negative indicators: heavy “college-prep” framing including PSAT, AP Calculus, competitive standing/-National Merit mentions (signals outcome/metrics orientation).

2) Positive vs. Negative comparison

- Positive hits: virtue, faith formation, character, truth, prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance, faith, hope, charity = 10
- Negative hits: college prep, PSAT, AP Calculus, competitive standing, National Merit recognition = 5
- Percent positive: ~67% (10/15)

3) Coverage estimate

- Good virtue/formation emphasis; less explicit “wisdom,” “wonder,” or TGB phrasing in mission copy. Estimated 60% coverage.

Score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Justification: Strong virtue/formation language is present, but substantial emphasis on test/outcome/college-prep framing tempers the classical purpose signal.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM Criteria highlights: liberal arts (Trivium/Quadrivium); Great Books; history (not “social studies”); wonder.

1) Keywords found

- Positive indicators: “modern and classical languages”; Latin (MS); “classic literature” with authors Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare, Dickens, Austen; theology; history; humane letters; world literature and ancient cultures.
- Negative indicators: none explicit (no “social studies” substitution, no PBL dominance language found).

2) Positive vs. Negative comparison

- Positive hits: classical languages, Latin, classic literature, Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare, history, theology, humane letters = 9
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%

3) Coverage estimate

- Evidence for Great Books/authors, Latin, history terminology proper. No explicit “Trivium/Quadrivium” or “Great Conversation” language surfaced; estimated 65% coverage.

Score: CLASSICAL Justification: Great Books/authors and Latin are present, with a humanities emphasis extending to ancient cultures. Despite missing explicit Trivium framing in public copy, the curricular content signals classical orientation.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS Criteria highlights: scholé/restful learning; singing/chanting/memorization in lower grades; Socratic discussion/seminars/debate in upper school; rhetoric speech/oration.

1) Keywords found

- Positive indicators (not found): no explicit “Socratic,” “Harkness/seminar,” “scholé/restful learning,” “chanting/recitation,” “rhetoric speeches” located.
- Negative indicators found: “hands-on exploration and discovery” (signals experiential-learning emphasis) in HS science labs copy; “rigorous” emphasis appears elsewhere; neither is inherently anti-classical, but “experiential/hands-on” is a negative signal in the classical lexicon if it dominates the pedagogy language.

2) Positive vs. Negative comparison

- Positive hits: 0
- Negative hits: experiential/hands-on = 1

- Percent positive: 0%

3) Coverage estimate

- Very limited explicit pedagogical claims that match classical pedagogy lexicon; estimated 10% coverage.

Score: NOT CLASSICAL Justification: Public materials do not highlight classical teaching forms (scholé, chant/memory, Socratic/seminar, rhetoric orations). "Hands-on" language appears, but classical markers are not visible.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY Criteria highlights: teachers as models/mentors; "living curriculum"; collegial "faculty of friends"; portrait of teacher/student.

1) Keywords found

- Faculty list includes "Humane Letters Teacher," but public copy does not frame faculty as "mentors," "models," "living curriculum," nor present a "portrait of a teacher/student" page.

2) Positive vs. Negative comparison

- Positive hits: 0 (title conventions alone do not meet the lexicon's positive indicators)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 0%

3) Coverage estimate

- No visible classical faculty ethos language; estimated 0% coverage.

Score: NOT CLASSICAL Justification: Absent explicit language about faculty formation, mentorship, or "portrait" expectations in public materials.

CATEGORY 6: PARENTS AND COMMUNITY Criteria highlights: parent partnership/co-teachers; parent formation/book studies; open campus/hospitality.

1) Keywords found

- Positive indicators: "we partner with families to form students into virtuous disciples of Christ"; "Parents appreciate how this program extends beyond the classroom" (virtue program tools going home); regular Open House invitations welcoming families on campus.
- Negative indicators: none surfaced.

2) Positive vs. Negative comparison

- Positive hits: partner with families; extension of formation to home; campus welcome/open house = 3
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%

3) Coverage estimate

- Evidence of partnership is present; no clear parent seminars/book clubs or ongoing parent formation articulated. Estimated 40% coverage.

Score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Justification: Partnership language and hospitality (open houses) appear, but systematic parent formation in classical philosophy is not evident.

Aggregate Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Strongest categories: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; Curriculum. - Mixed: Purpose and Goal; Parents & Community. - Weak/Absent: Pedagogy; Faculty.

Key Evidence Cited - Four-year theology; scripture; sacramental life; classic literature authors; college-prep/PSAT/National Merit; science labs language; integrated humanities; virtues program (cardinal + theological virtues); Latin; daily prayer/weekly Mass/Eucharist; Early Childhood catechesis and "truth/virtue/purpose"; Faculty titles (Humane Letters).

What would move the needle If Bishop Louis Reicher aims to present as fully Classical in public materials: - Name the Trivium and Rhetoric: Publish explicit references to grammar, logic, rhetoric; list formal logic/rhetoric courses (with student speeches, theses, or capstone orations) and sample rubrics/outcomes. - Make pedagogy visible: Describe Socratic/seminar methods in upper grades and chant/recitation/memory work in lower grades; show examples (photos/videos, schedules) and use the terms "Socratic," "seminar," "recitation/chant," "scholé/restful learning," and "progymnasmata" in Academics pages. - Emphasize formation over metrics: Rebalance public copy by foregrounding "wisdom and virtue," "truth, goodness, and beauty," and "wonder," while moving test/college metrics to secondary positions. - Faculty as the living curriculum: Publish a "Portrait of a Teacher" (virtue language, mentoring, lifelong learning, great books seminars for faculty) and "Portrait of a Graduate" (virtue, wisdom, rhetoric, civic friendship), using classical lexicon cues (faculty of friends, mentors, exemplars). - Parent formation: Offer visible parent education (book clubs on classical ed, great books evenings, talks on TGB/scholé) and highlight these on the site under "Parents/Community" to deepen the partnership beyond admissions events.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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